UNIT 3: TRAFFIC RULES AND REGULATIONS

Unit Objectives

At the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- listen to a text on traffic rules in Ethiopia;
- talk about common traffic rules to their classmates;
- conduct a role-play based on a dialogue;
- learn the meanings of vocabulary items related to traffic rules;
- use modals (should/ought to, have to, may, might, can, could…) while giving and receiving advice;
- comprehend a reading text;
- give and receive advice on the subject of the use of traffic rules and regulations using modals; and
- write a letter to a friend.

SECTION ONE: LISTENING

Lesson 1

Pre-Listening

Activity 3.1: In groups, answer each of the following questions.

1. What do we mean by rules?
2. What are the classroom rules which you and your classmates respect? Why do you respect these rules?
3. What are traffic rules?

Activity 3.2: Study the meanings of the following words with the help of your teacher and make a sentence.

pedestrian **sidewalks** **buckling**

While-Listening

Activity 3.3: Answer each of the following questions based on the listening text. Before you listen to the text, read the questions.

1. What is the title of the listening text you have heard?

A. New Traffic Rules in Addis Ababa B. New Traffic Rules

C. Top 5 Most Helpful New Rules D. The New Laws Have Good Intentions

2. Some of the cars should not be allowed to give transport services because _____.

A. they have mechanical problems B. they have engine problems

C. they are killers D. all are correct answers.

3. In contrast to the developing countries, Addis Abeba's traffic problems are _____ .

A. worth worrying B. dangerous ones

C. not worrying about D. worth talking about

4. In Addis Ababa, _____ .

A. sidewalks are used by pedestrians B. sidewalks are available

C. sidewalks are not used by pedestrians D. sidewalks are not available

5. Who violates traffic rules?

A. Pedestrian B. Taxi-drivers

C. Mini-bus drivers D. All are correct answers.

6. What was the good news about?

A. The revised traffic law B. Foot-travelers

C. Traffic laws D. Drivers

Lesson 2

Activity 3.4: According the listening text, complete the following sentences with the appropriate words, or expressions. Discuss you answers with your partner's.

1. Addis Ababa is continuously _____ and the number of cars on the road is growing on a _____.

2. Some of the cars should not be allowed to be on the road at all as they could be potential _____.

3. Many of the _____, especially cabs, that transport people, had _____ and _____ problems.

4. However, the recent traffic law changes in _____ triggered me into writing this _____.

5. For some reason, pedestrians like to share the _____ with _____ .

6. Yes, I agree that the new rules are _____ .

7. _____ _____ are compulsory for driver and front seat passenger.

8. These new set of rules are great if followed by all _____ and _____.

9. I hope that all will obey these rules and as a result, the roads of Addis Ababa will be _____ _____.

Lesson 3

Post-Listening

Activity 3.5: Read the traffic rules in the table below and rate each of them based on your beliefs as:

a) "Most Important" or

b) "Important" or

c) "Least Important".

Discuss your ratings and reasons with your group members'.

Importance of the Traffic Rules

No.	Traffic Rules	Importance			Reasons for your choice
		Most Important	Important	Least Important	
1	Always wear a seat-belt.				
2	Respect the speed limits.				
3	Follow traffic signals.				
4	Do not drink alcohol if you drive.				
5	Cross the road at the Zebra Crossing.				
6	Always walk on the pavement.				

SECTION TWO: SPEAKING

Lesson 4

Auxiliary Verbs *(can, should, must)*

Asking for Advice on Using Traffic Lights

Activity 3.6: Act out the dialogue in pairs and study how advice is requested and given.

At the Traffic Lights and Signs

A: What **should** I do if the traffic light turns red?

B: You **must** stop. You **must not** cross on any of the crossing lines.

A: What should I do when red arrow goes out, leaving only a green light?

B: You **may** proceed if it is safe to do so by observing other pedestrians crossing the road you are entering.

A: Should I cross when the traffic light turns yellow?

B: You **should not** cross, for it indicates that the lights are about to change to red. You **should not cross** unless you are so close to the zebra-crossing and should do the crossing soon.

A: Should I cross when the lights turn **a yellow arrow?**

B: This arrow indicates that the lights are about to change to red. You **must** prepare to stop and not enter the road beyond the stop line unless you are able to cross safely. You **may** cross if the yellow arrow goes out leaving only a green light. You will do this if it is safe to do so, but beware of oncoming vehicles.

A: **Can** I cross the road when the traffic lights turn green?

B: Green Lights? You **can** cross, if it is safe to do so.

SECTION THREE: Reading

Lesson 5

Pre-reading

Activity 3.7: Do the following questions in your groups.

1. Have you ever seen or heard about a car accident? Tell your group members about it.
2. Write causes for car accidents. Compare your list with your partner's.
3. How does it damage the life of human beings and their properties?

Activity 3.8: Read the following words and learn their meanings with the help of teacher.

devastating **gravity**

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Road traffic accident: a major public health problem in Ethiopia

1. A secondary data collected by the Amhara National Regional State Police Commission from 2007-2011 shows that road traffic accidents are serious, but neglected health problems in Ethiopia. **Fatalities due to traffic accidents are reported to be among the highest in the world.** According to the World Health Organisations' global status report on road safety, the road crash **fatality** rate in Ethiopia was at least 114 deaths per 10,000 vehicles per year. This is only 10 in the UK and Ireland and 60 across 39 sub-Saharan African countries. In addition, the number of people injured or killed in one crash in Ethiopia is about 30 times higher than that in the US. Furthermore, it is sad to note that fatalities due to road traffic accidents are higher among **pedestrians in countries like Ethiopia than in developed countries**. For instance, 60% of the fatalities in the US account to the car drivers, while in Ethiopia only about 5% account to drivers. **This** is also supported by a recent study where the majority of fatalities were **pedestrians** (87%) followed by **passengers** (9%) and **drivers** (4%), among a total of 25,110 accidents and 3415 fatalities during the period 2000-2009 in Addis Ababa.
2. The economic implications of traffic accidents are highly devastating especially for developing countries, since deaths due to these causes are highest among the most economically active population whose ages are between 15-59 years. A study has estimated the total health and life-related cost of motor vehicle injuries in Addis Ababa in 2010 to be about 31,692,892 Ethiopian Birr, which shows the seriousness of the problem.
3. In spite of the fact that road traffic accident is a huge public health development problem in Ethiopia with significant impact on morbidity, mortality as well as devastating economic effects; proportionate measures have not been taken to address the problem. According to the WHO's global status report mentioned above, even though Ethiopia has put in place relevant laws on traffic speed limits, the effectiveness of their overall enforcement was only 2 (in a scale of 0-10) in 2009. There are **some laws** on road safety management and on major risk factors in the country. However, they seem to be largely nominal, as the country neither strictly enforces speed limits on urban roads nor controls blood alcohol levels in drunk-driving.
4. Overall, the **gravity** of the problem is getting worse from time to time, approaching a crisis level and requiring urgent and multi-pronged actions. Multi-sectorial and combined enforcement strategies are **the most efficient way to respond to the crisis**. In addition, there is an urgent need for interventions that can address **risk factors** such as **speeding, improper use of lanes, and drunk-driving,** which have important public health implications as large proportion of traffic injuries are attributed to them

Slightly Adapted from Ethiopian Journal of Health and Development, 2014:28.

Lesson 6

While-reading

Direct questions

Activity 3.9: Identify whether each of the following sentences is true or false. Write your reasons for your answer and discuss them in groups.

1. Ethiopia stands first in the word in the traffic road accident.
2. The road traffic accident fatalities in Ethiopia were approximately 11 times greater than the UK.
3. The major traffic accident fatalities were drivers.
4. The active population of Ethiopia was the most affected by the road traffic accidents.
5. Ethiopia has succeeded in implementing its traffic laws.
6. Ethiopian drivers were not grouped from the majority of fatalities.
7. The majority of traffic injuries in Ethiopia are due to speeding, improper use of lanes and drunk driving.
8. Ethiopia practices controlling of drunk-driving and speed limits

Lesson 7

Activity 3.10: Individually, answers each of these questions and then discuss your answers in groups.

1. Where did the writer get the information about the road traffic accident, Paragraph 1?
2. Why does the writer label speeding, improper use of lanes, and drunk-driving as risk factors, Paragraph 4?
3. How many years of road traffic accident report did the writer use while writing this text, Paragraph1?
4. What was the road accident fatality rate in Ethiopia in the years 2009, Paragraph1?
5. What was the road accident fatality rate in UK, Ireland and the Sub-Saharan Africa in the same year, Paragraph1?
6. What does the estimated 31,692,892 Ethiopian Birr of the life-related cost of motor vehicle injuries in Addis Ababa in 2010 indicate, Paragraph 2?
7. What is the contradiction mentioned by the author/write in Paragraph 3?
8. Why has Ethiopia not succeeded in decreasing traffic road accidents, Paragraph 3?

Lesson 8

Inferential questions

Activity 3.11: In pairs, answer each of the following questions. Then, discuss in your groups.

1. Why did the author sequentially mention evidence from the WHO's 2009 global status report and the recent study?
2. What has hindered Ethiopia from implementing its relevant laws it has approved on traffic speed limits, road safety management and major risk factors?
3. Why did the write conclude that the economic implications of traffic accidents are highly damaging in developing nations?
4. Why did the road traffic accident solutions require multi-sectorial and combined enforcement strategies?
5. What were the solutions suggested by the writer to solve the risk factors?

Lesson 9

Referential questions

Activity 3.12: Individually, write out what each of the following words refers to. Then, check your answers with your partner's.

1. The word '…secondary…', in Paragraph 1, Line 1 refers to _____
2. In Paragraph 1, the 4th line from the last, the pronoun, 'This…'refers to _____
3. In Paragraph 2, Line 2, the pronoun, '…these…' refers _____
4. In Paragraph 2, the last line, the phrase, "…the problem…" means _____
5. The words, '…laws…' in Paragraph 3, Line 4 and '…laws….' in Paragraph 3, line 6 refers to _____ and _____
6. 'The problem…' in Paragraphs 3, Line 6 means _____
7. The pronoun, '….they…' in Paragraph 3, the 2nd line from the last means_____
8. The pronoun, '….them' in Paragraph 4, the last line refers to _____

Lesson 10

Activity 3.13: Based on the reading passage, what do the following words and expressions refer to? Check your answers with your partner's.

1. In Paragraph 1, Line 2, the word, '…neglected …' roughly means _____
2. The word, '…rate…' in Paragraph 1, Line 5, means_____
3. In Paragraph 1, Line 7, the phrase, '…30 times…' means _____
4. The word, '…pedestrians…' in Paragraph 1, Line 9 _____
5. Roughly, the verb phrase '…accounts for …' in Paragraph 1, the 5th line from the last, _____
6. The phrase, '…active population' in Paragraph 2, Line 2-3, approximately means _____
7. The word '…enforcement…' in Paragraph 3, Line 5, means _____
8. In Paragraph 3, the 2ndline from the last, , 'nominal…' roughly means _____
9. The word, '…implication…' in Paragraph 4, the last, means _____

Lesson 11

Post-reading

Activity 3.14: In your groups, answer the following questions.

1. Discuss major causes of road traffic accidents in Ethiopia.
2. List down solutions that can help to reduce traffic accidents? Then, compare your list with your partner's.
3. If you were a minister of transport what would you do to minimise the road traffic accidents in Ethiopia?

SECTION FOUR: Vocabulary

Lesson 12

Activity 3.15: Based on the given sample, write a sentence using each expression. Then, discuss your sentences with a partner's.

Example:

Traffic rules

Knowing **traffic rules** is important for safety.

Speed limit

Knowing the **speed limit** for all the roads is important for safe driving.

Driving rules

Knowing **driving rules** is important for safe driving.

old vehicles	traffic jam	traffic-laws	traffic light
traffic restrictions	traffic accident	traffic regulations	

SECTION FIVE: Grammar

Lesson 13

Asking for and giving advice on traffic tights and turn signals

Uses of Modal verbs:

- ***must/must not,***
- ***can/ cannot, and***
- ***should/should not.***

Notes:

- We use **can** to say something is possible or allowed. Somebody has the ability to do it.

  Example: I can cross the road when the traffic light turns green.

- We use **must** to say that we believe something is **certain**.

  Example: we must not cross the road when the traffic light turns red.

- We use **should** to mean it is a good thing or the right thing to do.

  Example: we should use a zebra-crossing.

Activity 3.16:Based on the given situations (1-6) below, choose the appropriate form (s) of modal verbs: must/must not, can/ cannot, and should/should not.

Traffic Lights and Traffic Symbols

Situation 1: At the Red Light

1. A red light means you **(must, can, should)** stop. You **(must, can, should)** stop as close as possible behind the 'stop' line.

Traffic light showing red signal

Situation 2: At the Yellow (Amber) Light

2. A yellow (amber) light means you **(must, can, shall)** stop. You **(can, must, shall)** only go through a yellow light if you **(cannot, must not, shall not)** stop safely before the 'Stop' line. You **(should not, could not, had not)** stop suddenly, and you **(should not, could not, had not)** speed up to get through a yellow light.

Situation 3: At the Green Light

(3) A green light means you **(can, shall, must)** go through the intersection if it's safe to do so. You **(must, can, shall)** also follow these rules for temporary traffic lights at roadworks.

Traffic light showing green signal

On the Use Turn Signals

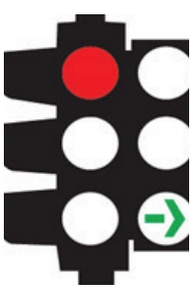
Situation 4: The Red Arrow

A red arrow means you must not turn. You (**must, can, shall**) stop behind the 'Stop' line until the arrow turns green or disappears.

Traffic light showing a green light and a red right arrow indicate that you **(must not, cannot, shall not)** turn right - you **(can, must, shall)** go straight ahead or turn left.

Situation 5: The Green Arrow

A green arrow means you **(can, must, shall)** turn in that direction.



Situation 6: The Yellow (Amber) Arrow

A yellow (amber) arrow means you **(must, can, shall)** stop. You **(can, must, shall)** only go through a yellow light if you cannot stop safely before the 'Stop' line.

When a yellow (amber) arrow is flashing, this means you **(can, must, shall)** turn in that direction. You **(must, can, shall)** give way to pedestrians crossing the road you're turning into.

Traffic light showing a flashing yellow right arrow, indicates that you **(can, must, shall)** turn right as long as you give way to pedestrians.

Lesson 14

Activity 3.17: For questions 1 - 10, choose one of the most appropriate modal axillaries given in the boxes below. Check your answers with your group members'.

may	may not	shall	must not	can
have	do not have to	should	should not	cannot

1. If you drive a car, you (should, must, can) ____ have a driving license.
2. You (shouldn't, mustn't, don't have to) ____ drink a lot and drive.
3. When you are in a car, you (should, must, may) ____ wear a seatbelt.
4. When driving a car, you (shouldn't, mustn't, can't) ____ listen to the radio.
5. You (should, must, have) ____ to pay road tax if you own a car.
6. You (should, must, have) ____ stop at a red traffic light.
7. When you ride a motorbike you (should, must, have) ____ wear a helmet.
8. You (should, must, can) ____ smoke while you are driving.
9. If you own a car, you (should, must, can) ____ have insurance.
10. You (shouldn't, mustn't, don't have to) ___exceed the speed limit.

SECTION SIX: Writing

Lesson 15

A friendly letter

Activity 3.18: Based on the letter given below, answer each of the following questions. Discuss your answers in groups.

a) When was the letter written?

b) Who wrote the letter?

c) To whom was the letter written?

d) Write words and expressions you do not know.

e) Identify the main message of the letter.

f) What is the purpose of this letter?

Irispins International School
B.O. Box 202020
Kebele 14, Minilik II Sub- City, Bahir Dar

5th September 2021

Dear Barsanat,

Hi! I hope you got the letter. Your exams are cancelled. But I am going to tell you one good thi today.
Nowadays, many accidents are taking place in every city. The main reason is violating traffic rules. We should follow traffic rules while driving. Otherwise, it is very dangerous for you and for your family.
Tell this to all your friends and families.
Thank you.
(Signature)

Maryamawit

Lesson 16

Activity 3.19: In your group, compare Picture A with Picture B below and discuss the following questions.

a) In which of the pictures have people violated traffic rules? Why?
b) In which of the pictures have people respected traffic rules? Why?
c) What do you tell people who have violated traffic rules?

Picture A

Picture B

Activity 3.20: Be in groups and list down three cautions/cares school children have to do when they cross roads. Write three rules that school children should respect.

School children must respect the following three traffic rules to keep themselves safe from traffic accidents. Firstly, _____.Secondly, _____ _____.Thirdly, _____ _____ _____.Finally, _____ .